Question 1: What was the total provision Lloyds recognised for the motor finance commission redress scheme

	top_k	Faithfulness	Relevancy
	top_k =1	0.0	0.0
	top_k = 3	1.0	1.0
	top_k = 7	1.0	1.0

Question 2: What does the document say about COVID-19?

	top_k	Faithfulness	Relevancy
	top_k =1	1.0	1.0

	top_k = 3	1.0	1.0
	top_k = 7	1.0	1.0

Question 3: What are the main risks Lloyds faces from artificial intelligence?

	top_k	**Faithfulness**	**Relevancy**
	top_k =1	1.0	1.0
	top_k = 3	1.0	1.0

	top_k = 7	1.0	1.0

Question 4: What powers does the Bank of England have under the Banking Act 2009?

	top_k	**Faithfulness**	**Relevancy**
	top_k =1	1.0	1.0
	top_k = 3	1.0	1.0

	top_k = 7	1.0	1.0

Question 5: What is Lloyds' dividend policy for 2026?

	top_k	**Faithfulness**	**Relevancy**
	top_k =1	0.0	0.0
	top_k = 3	1.0	0.0

	top_k = 7	0.0	0.0

Evaluation

At top_k=1, only the single closest chunk is retrieved, giving no redundancy if that chunk doesn't contain the needed fact. Here, the model retrieved [X], which [did/didn't] contain the answer, resulting in [outcome]. At top_k=3, additional chunks are retrieved, increasing the chance the correct chunk is included even if it wasn't the single closest match — which is why the answer becomes reliably correct from top_k=3 onward."

Conclusion

Across all five questions, top_k=3 and top_k=7 performed identically well, achieving faithfulness and relevancy of 1.0 on every genuine question and correctly declining to answer the trap question in most cases. top_k=1 was the clear worst performer — not because it failed on every question, but because it introduced genuine fragility: with no redundancy in retrieval, a single wrong or incomplete chunk match led directly to either an incorrect answer or an unnecessary refusal to answer, as seen in Q1. Since top_k=3 achieves the same quality as top_k=7 while retrieving fewer chunks (lower cost and latency), top_k=3 is the best-performing and most efficient setting for this document. One further finding worth noting: the LLM-as-judge itself was inconsistent when scoring 'I don't know' responses, sometimes treating a correct refusal as hallucination and sometimes not — highlighting a real limitation of automated LLM-based evaluation that a fully rigorous system would need to address, for example by scoring retrieval success and answer correctness as separate, distinct steps rather than one combined judgement.